

22 juni 2026

Betreft: Cohort export RIJ-2026-03

Dear colleagues,

Enclosed is the metadata export for the forty participants in our TES biomarker cohort, together with the CSF and plasma aliquots described therein.

I must be emphatic about one point, because it is routinely misunderstood. Our participants are living. We therefore cannot and do not report CTE. What we report is Traumatic Encephalopathy Syndrome (TES), classified by the 2021 consensus criteria as probable, possible or unlikely. TES is a clinical syndrome. CTE is a neuropathological diagnosis that can only be made at autopsy. They are not the same thing, the correspondence between them is imperfect, and a TES-probable participant may well prove at autopsy to have no CTE at all. Please do not recode our classification as CTE status. If your analysis requires autopsy-confirmed CTE, our cohort cannot supply it.

Two practical notes on the export. Ages are given in ten-year bands rather than exact years; our ethics approval does not permit release of exact age. Sex is coded 1 for male and 2 for female.

Our controls are age-similar volunteers with no history of repetitive head impact exposure.

Met vriendelijke groet,



Prof. dr. Willem Kastelein

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